



Mastering the Art of Storytelling

Sequencing and Discourse Markers for
Adult Learners



MyMindful
English

Why do some stories stick?

The Power of Flow

Have you ever listened to someone tell a story that felt like a messy list of facts? Without **discourse markers**, even the most exciting event becomes confusing.

In business and life, these markers act as **roadmaps**, helping your listener follow your logic and feel the impact of your message.

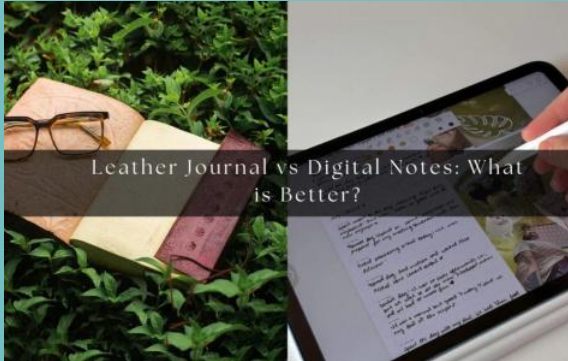
Key point

Discourse markers don't just connect words; they signal *meaning* and *intent* to your audience.



The Narrative Toolkit

VOCABULARY



Narrative

The structured account of events; the 'shape' of your story.



Impact

The measurable or emotional effect your story has on the listener.



Values

Core principles or beliefs, such as 'teamwork' or 'innovation'.

Step-by-Step: Sequencing



Ordering Events

To keep a story clear, use **sequencing markers** to show the chronological order.

- **Beginning:** First, To start...
- **Middle:** Then, Afterwards, Later...
- **End:** Finally, At last...

Example

First, we identified the budget leak. *Then*, we changed our software. *Finally*, we saved 20%.

Overcoming Challenges

Listen to the audio and answer the questions



A Presentation Success Story

▶ Play audio

- 1 What technical problem occurred at the start of the presentation?
- 2 How did Carlos manage the situation while the cables were being fixed?
- 3 What was the direct result of Carlos's quick thinking regarding the investors?
- 4 What lesson did the team learn from this experience?

Answers on the next slide...

Overcoming Challenges



Check your answers below



A Presentation Success Story

► Play audio

1

The projector stopped working just as the CEO entered the room.

2

He explained the data from memory and focused on the company's core values.

3

The investors decided to double their initial investment in the company.

4

They learned that true preparation means knowing the material well rather than just relying on slides.

Adding Friction: Contrast

The Unexpected Turn

Every great story needs a challenge. Use **contrast markers** to highlight obstacles or surprising changes.

- **Common markers:** *However, although, but, yet, on the other hand.*

The project seemed perfect. However, we forgot to check the local regulations. – Project Lead



Cause, Effect, and Closing

Cause & Effect

Explain *why* things happened and their results.

- **Because:** Introduces the reason.
- **Therefore / As a result:** Introduces the consequence.

Example

We worked late; *consequently*, we finished the report early.

Closing the Loop

Signal the end and summarize the lesson.

- **In conclusion**
- **Ultimately**
- **In the end**

Remember

Closing markers connect the 'what happened' to the 'why it matters'.

Match the Marker to its Function

1.

At last

a) To introduce a contrast or concession.

2.

Although

b) To show a logical result or consequence.

3.

Therefore

c) To indicate the final event after a long time.

4.

What's more

d) To add information or emphasize a point.

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Putting it Together



ACTIVITY

Structure your Narrative

When telling a professional story, follow this flow:

1. **Setup:** Use 'First'.
2. **Conflict:** Use 'However'.
3. **Resolution:** Use 'Therefore'.
4. **Lesson:** Use 'Ultimately'.

Speaking Challenge



Tell a story about a time you solved a problem at work or university. Use at least one sequencing marker, one contrast marker, and one cause-effect marker. End by stating the impact on your team.

Speaking Challenge



You might have said...

I identified the missing data (First).

We lacked time (However).

We collaborated across departments (Therefore).

We finished on time and improved communication (Ultimately).